

Word family: **will / would / willing / willingly / willingness / unwilling / willpower**

Base word: will

Negative: will not / won't

Past/conditional related modal: would

Noun: will

Lexical verb: will / willed / willing

Related forms: willing, willingly, willingness, unwilling, unwillingly, willpower

Useful constructions/extensions: will happen, will become, will probably, I'll help, will you...?, won't, will not, a strong will, lose the will to..., last will and testament, make a will, will something to someone, willing to, unwilling to, willpower

Part of speech: modal verb (情態動詞) / noun (名詞) / lexical verb (一般動詞)

Your passage contains:

> "I know that one day these visits **will become memories**."

Here, **will** means:

the speaker expects this future event to happen.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> **these visits will become memories**

will expresses:

a future development that the speaker sees as certain or highly expected.

The speaker knows that:

- * the grandmother is getting older;
- * these weekly visits cannot continue forever;
- * eventually, the visits will exist only in memory.

Meaning: Used to state or predict what is expected to happen in the future.

繁體中文: **表示說話者預期未來會發生的事情；這裡指這些探訪有一天終會成為回憶**

中文翻譯:

> “I know that one day these visits will become memories.”

「我知道有一天，這些探訪**終究會變成回憶**。」

So:

will become = 將會變成 / 終會變成

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. **will = future prediction/expectation (將會) — 會 ; 將會**

This is the exact passage meaning.

****Meaning:**** Used to say what you expect or believe will happen in the future.

Practice 1 — Original

> “One day these visits **will become memories**.”

「有一天，這些探訪**會變成回憶**。」

Practice 2

> “The weather **will improve** tomorrow.”

「明天天氣**會改善**。」

Practice 3

> “She **will probably arrive** before six.”

「她**大概會**在六點前到。」

****will = 表示說話者對未來事件的預測 / 預期****

2. **will = future fact (未來事實) — 將會**

A closely related use.

Practice 4

> “She **will** be eighty next year.”

「她明年**將會八十歲**。」

Practice 5

> “The meeting **will** begin at nine.”

「會議**將於九點開始**。」

will = 表示按時間、安排或自然發展將在未來成立的情況

3. **will** = spontaneous decision (即場決定) — 我來..... / 我會.....

A major conversational use.

Practice 6

> “The phone is ringing. I **will** answer it.”

「電話響了。**我來接**。」

Practice 7

> “I **will** take the blue one.”

「**我要 / 我選**藍色那個。」

will = 在說話當刻作出的即時決定

This is different from a previously arranged plan.

4. **I'll**... = offer to do something (主動提出幫忙) — 我來.....

Practice 8

> “I **will** carry the bags for you.”

「**我幫你拿**袋子吧。」

Practice 9

> “I’ll make the tea.”

「**我來泡茶吧。**」

I’ll + verb = 主動提出自己願意做某事

5. **will = willingness (願意) — 願意 ; 肯**

A major modal meaning.

Practice 10

> “She **will help** if you ask her.”

「如果你開口，她**會願意幫忙**。」

Practice 11

> “He **won’t listen** to anyone.”

「他**就是不肯聽**任何人的話。」

will / won’t = 表示某人願意 / 不願意做某事

This is not merely future time.

6. **won’t = refusal (不肯) — 拒絕 ; 就是不願意**

A very important meaning.

Practice 12

> “He **won’t apologize**.”

「他**就是不肯道歉**。」

Practice 13

> “She won’t accept any help.”

「她**不肯接受**任何幫助。」

****won't = 某人拒絕 / 不願意進行某項行動****

7. ****will = promise (承諾) — 會 ; 一定會****

Practice 14

> “I ****will call you**** tonight.”

「我今晚****一定會打給你****。」

Practice 15

> “I promise I ****will help****.”

「我答應你，我****會幫忙****。」

****will = 用來承諾自己未來會採取某項行動****

8. ****will = determination (堅決要) — 一定要 ; 決意****

A stronger emphatic use.

Practice 16

> “I ****will finish**** this today.”

「我今天****一定要完成****這件事。」

Practice 17

> “We will not give up.”

「我們****決不放棄****。」

****will = 表示強烈決心 , 說話者堅定要某事發生****

9. ****Will you...? = request (可以請你.....嗎 ?) — 請求****

A major interpersonal use.

Practice 18

> “**Will you help me?**”

「你**可以幫我嗎？**」

Practice 19

> “Will you close the door?”

「你**可以把門關上嗎？**」

Will you...? = 詢問對方是否願意做某事，常用作請求

10. **Will you...? = asking about willingness (你願意.....嗎?) — 願不願意**

Practice 20

> “**Will you come with us?**”

「你**願意跟我們一起去嗎？**」

Practice 21

> “Will you stay for dinner?”

「你**願意留下來吃飯嗎？**」

will you = 詢問對方的意願

Context distinguishes this from a polite request.

11. **will = typical/habitual behaviour (總會 ; 往往會) — 常常會**

A major but often overlooked sense.

Practice 22

> “Children **will ask** difficult questions.”

「孩子**總會問**一些難答的問題。」

Practice 23

> “He **will sit** there for hours reading.”

「他**常常**會坐在那裡幾個小時看書。」

will = 表示某人 / 某物具有典型、反覆出現的行為模式

This does not primarily refer to future time.

12. **will** = characteristic tendency (就是會) — 往往；總是

Practice 24

> “Accidents **will happen**.”

「意外**總會**發生。」

Practice 25

> “People will make mistakes.”

「人**總會**犯錯。」

will = 表示一般人性、自然規律或常見傾向

13. **will** = strong inference/prediction about the present (想必；應該是) — 大概；想必

A useful inferential use.

Practice 26

> “That **will be** John at the door.”

「門口那個**大概就是** John。」

Practice 27

> “You **will have heard** the news by now.”

「你現在**大概已經聽說**那個消息了。」

****will = 根據情況作出很有把握的推斷****

This is not simply future reference.

14. ****will = inevitable result (自然會 ; 必然會) — 會 ; 必然****

Practice 28

> “If you heat ice, it ****will melt****.”

「如果把冰加熱，它****會融化****。」

Practice 29

> “Without water, the plant will die.”

「沒有水，植物****會枯死****。」

****will = 表示某條件下自然 / 必然出現的結果****

15. ****will not / won't = failure of a thing to function (就是不.....) — 怎樣都不 ; 無法正常****

A useful non-human use.

Practice 30

> “The car ****won't start****.”

「車子****怎樣也發動不了****。」

Practice 31

> “The door ****won't open****.”

「這扇門****就是打不開****。」

****won't + inanimate subject = 某物拒絕般地無法正常運作 / 達成預期結果****

This is idiomatic personification rather than literal willingness.

16. **will = noun: determination (意志 ; 決心) — 意志力 ; 決心**

Now **will** is a noun.

Meaning: Mental determination to continue or achieve something.

Practice 32

> “She has a **strong will**.”

「她有很強的**意志力**。」

Practice 33

> “His will to succeed kept him going.”

「他想成功的**強烈意志**令他堅持下去。」

will = 使一個人堅持、作選擇或克服困難的內在決心

17. **strong will (堅強意志) — 意志堅強**

Practice 34

> “Her **strong will** helped her through difficult times.”

「她的**堅強意志**幫助她捱過困難時期。」

Practice 35

> “He succeeded through talent and a strong will.”

「他靠才能和**堅強意志**取得成功。」

strong will = 不容易被困難動搖的堅定決心

18. **will to live / will to survive (生存意志) — 求生意志**

Practice 36

> “She never lost her **will to live**.”

「她從未失去**求生意志**。」

Practice 37

> “His will to survive was extraordinary.”

「他的**求生意志**非常強。」

will to do = 推動某人堅持做某事的內在意志 / 決心

19. **lose the will to do something (失去做某事的意欲 / 意志) — 失去動力**

Practice 38

> “He almost **lost the will to continue**.”

「他幾乎**失去了繼續下去的意志**。」

Practice 39

> “Repeated failure made her lose the will to try.”

「一次又一次失敗令她**失去了再嘗試的意欲**。」

lose the will to do = 不再有足夠決心 / 動力繼續

20. **willpower (意志力) — 自制力 ; 毅力**

A major related compound.

Practice 40

> “It takes **willpower** to change a habit.”

「改變習慣需要**意志力**。」

Practice 41

> “She showed remarkable willpower.”

「她展現出非常強的**自制力 / 意志力**。」

****willpower = 控制衝動、堅持目標、克服困難的心理力量****

21. ****will = noun: legal document (遺囑) — 遺囑****

A completely separate noun meaning.

****Meaning:**** A legal document stating what should happen to someone's property after their death.

Practice 42

> “She made a ****will****.”

「她立了****遺囑****。」

Practice 43

> “His will divided the property among his children.”

「他的****遺囑****把財產分給孩子們。」

****a will = 說明某人死後財產、資產等如何處理的法律文件****

22. ****make/write a will (立遺囑) — 訂立遺囑****

Practice 44

> “Everyone should consider ****making a will****.”

「每個人都可以考慮****立遺囑****。」

Practice 45

> “He wrote his will many years ago.”

「他很多年前已經****寫好了遺囑****。」

****make a will = 正式訂立死後財產安排的法律文件****

23. ****last will and testament (遺囑) — 最後遺囑****

A formal legal expression.

Practice 46

> “This document is his **last will and testament**.”

「這份文件是他的**最後遺囑**。」

Practice 47

> “The lawyer prepared her last will and testament.”

「律師替她準備了**正式遺囑**。」

last will and testament = 正式法律用語，指遺囑

24. **will** = verb: leave property by will (遺贈) — 立遺囑把.....留給

A separate lexical verb.

Practice 48

> “She **willed** the house to her daughter.”

「她在遺囑中把房子**留給女兒**。」

Practice 49

> “He **willed** most of his money to charity.”

「他透過遺囑把大部分金錢**留給慈善機構**。」

will something to someone = 在遺囑中指定某項財產由某人 / 機構繼承

25. **will** = verb: make something happen through mental determination (憑意志促使) — 憑意志力令.....

A less common but established literary/formal sense.

Practice 50

> “She seemed to **will** herself to stay awake.”

「她似乎靠**意志力強迫自己保持清醒**。」

Practice 51

> “He willed himself not to react.”

「他靠**意志控制自己不要作出反應**。」

will yourself to do = 靠強烈意志迫使 / 鼓勵自己做某事

26. **willing (願意的) — 願意 ; 樂意**

A major family adjective.

Practice 52

> “She is always **willing to help**.”

「她總是**樂意幫忙**。」

Practice 53

> “Are you willing to try?”

「你**願意試試嗎？**」

willing = 已準備好 / 樂意選擇做某件事，而不是被迫

27. **be willing to do (願意做) — 願意**

Practice 54

> “He was **willing to listen**.”

「他**願意聽**。」

Practice 55

> “I’m willing to learn.”

「我**願意學習**。」

****be willing to do = 對進行某項行動持接受 / 自願態度****

28. ****willingly (自願地 ; 樂意地) — 樂意地 ; 自願地****

Practice 56

> “She ****willingly helped**** everyone.”

「她****樂意地****幫助大家。」

Practice 57

> “He willingly accepted the responsibility.”

「他****自願 / 樂意地****承擔了責任。」

****willingly = 並非被迫，而是出於自己意願去做****

29. ****willingness (意願) — 願意程度 ; 意願****

Practice 58

> “Her ****willingness to help**** impressed me.”

「她****樂意助人的態度****令我印象深刻。」

Practice 59

> “Success requires a willingness to learn.”

「成功需要****願意學習的態度****。」

****willingness = 願意接受 / 進行某事的心理態度****

30. ****unwilling (不願意的) — 不情願 ; 不願****

Practice 60

> “He was ****unwilling to apologize****.”

「他**不願意道歉**。」

Practice 61

> “She seemed unwilling to discuss the problem.”

「她似乎**不願意討論**這個問題。」

unwilling = 不想 / 不願選擇做某事

31. **against someone's will (違背某人意願) — 違背意願 ; 非自願**

A major noun expression.

Practice 62

> “He was taken there **against his will**.”

「他是在**違背自己意願**的情況下被帶到那裡。」

Practice 63

> “Nobody should be forced to stay against their will.”

「不應強迫任何人在**違背本人意願**的情況下留下。」

against someone's will = 某件事在當事人不願意的情況下被強迫發生

32. **of your own free will (出於自願) — 自願地 ; 自由意志下**

Practice 64

> “She came **of her own free will**.”

「她是**自願前來的**。」

Practice 65

> “He signed the document of his own free will.”

「他是**出於自己意願**簽署文件的。」

****of your own free will = 沒有被強迫，由自己自由選擇****

33. ****free will (自由意志) — 自由意志****

A major philosophical/general compound.

Practice 66

> “The debate concerns ****free will**** and choice.”

「這場討論涉及****自由意志****和選擇。」

Practice 67

> “Do people have complete free will?”

「人是否擁有完全的****自由意志****？」

****free will = 人能否獨立、自主作出選擇的能力 / 概念****

34. ****at will (隨意地；任意) — 隨意；任意****

A major fixed expression.

Practice 68

> “Users can change the setting ****at will****.”

「使用者可以****隨意****更改設定。」

Practice 69

> “The door can be opened at will.”

「這扇門可以****隨時 / 任意****打開。」

****at will = 按自己的意願，在想要時自由地做****

35. ****will = desire/intention represented collectively (意願) — 意志；意願****

A broader noun sense.

Practice 70

> “The decision reflected the **will** of the people.”

「這個決定反映了人民的**意願**。」

Practice 71

> “They ignored the public will.”

「他們忽視了公眾的**意願**。」

will = 個人 / 群體真正想要某結果發生的意向

Important distinction: **will** = future vs be going to

This is one of the most important contrasts.

will

often expresses:

- * prediction;
- * spontaneous decision;
- * promise;
- * willingness.

be going to

often expresses:

- * prior intention;
- * prediction based on present evidence.

Compare:

> “I’ll call her.”

often an immediate decision/promise.

> “I’m going to call her tonight.”

sounds more like an existing plan.

Important distinction: **will** vs present continuous for arrangements

will

> "I'll see her tomorrow."

can be prediction/decision.

present continuous

> "I'm seeing her tomorrow."

usually indicates a definite personal arrangement.

So English has several ways to talk about the future.

Will is not simply 'the future tense.'

Important distinction: **will** vs **can**

Your passage contains both:

> "these visits **will** become memories"

and:

> "while I **can**."

will

= expected future development.

can

= present opportunity/possibility.

So:

> will = what is expected to happen

> can = what circumstances currently allow.

Important distinction: **will vs would**

will

often refers to present willingness/future prediction.

would

can express:

- * past habitual behaviour;
- * hypothetical result;
- * polite willingness/request;
- * future viewed from the past.

Compare:

> “She will help.”

= 她會幫忙。

> “She would help if you asked.”

= 如果你開口，她會幫忙。

Important distinction: **will vs shall**

In modern everyday English:

will

is the normal future modal for all persons.

shall

survives mainly in:

- * formal/legal English;
- * offers/suggestions such as “Shall we...?” especially British English.

So learners should normally use:

- > I will
- > we will

rather than treating **shall** as mandatory.

Important distinction: **will = prediction vs promise**

Compare:

- > “It will rain tomorrow.”

= prediction.

- > “I will call you tomorrow.”

could be:

- * prediction/intention;
- * promise.

Context and tone determine the function.

Important distinction: **will = future vs willingness**

Compare:

- > “She will arrive at six.”

= expected future event.

- > “She will help if you ask.”

= she is willing to help.

Same modal, different function.

Important distinction: **won't = future negative vs refusal**

Compare:

> “It won’t rain tomorrow.”

= prediction that rain will not happen.

> “He won’t apologize.”

= he refuses to apologize.

The second is about willingness, not merely future time.

Important distinction: **won’t work vs doesn’t work**

doesn’t work

= generally not functioning.

won’t work

often means:

> despite attempts, it refuses/fails to function now.

> “My key won’t turn.”

= 怎樣試都轉不到.

This use gives an inanimate object a kind of “refusal.”

Important distinction: **will = prediction vs must = strong deduction**

will

can make a confident inference:

> “That’ll be John.”

must

often expresses stronger logical deduction:

> “That must be John.”

Both infer, but nuance differs.

Important distinction: **will** = habit vs used to

will

can describe typical repeated behaviour, especially characteristically:

> “He will sit there for hours.”

used to

describes a past habit/state that no longer necessarily applies:

> “He used to sit there for hours.”

Will in this habitual sense is not limited to the past.

Important distinction: **will** = habit vs always

always

directly marks frequency.

will

can mark characteristic/tendency:

> “Children will ask questions.”

This sounds more like:

> that is what children characteristically do.

Important distinction: **will** — modal vs will — determination

Compare:

> “She **will** arrive tomorrow.”

Here **will** is a modal.

versus:

> “She has a strong **will**.”

Here **will** is a noun meaning:

> determination.

Different grammar and meaning.

Important distinction: **will vs **willpower****

**will**

= determination/intention more broadly.

**willpower**

= psychological self-control used to resist temptation or persist toward a goal.

> strong will

= strong determination.

> willpower to avoid sweets

= self-control.

Important distinction: **will vs **willingness****

**will**

noun:

> determination or intention.

**willingness**

= readiness to voluntarily do something.

> strong will

= 意志堅強

> willingness to help

= 樂意幫忙

Not the same.

Important distinction: ****willing vs able****

****willing****

= wants/is prepared to do it.

****able****

= has the capacity to do it.

Someone can be:

> willing but unable

or:

> able but unwilling.

This is a crucial distinction.

Important distinction: ****will vs wish****

****will****

as a noun emphasizes determination/intention.

****wish****

= desire or hope.

> “I wish I could go.”

does not necessarily imply determination.

Important distinction: **will** — legal document vs intention

Compare:

> “It was his **will** to leave.”

= 意願 / 決心.

versus:

> “It was written in his **will**.”

= 寫在遺囑裡.

Context distinguishes them.

Important distinction: **will** = legal document vs inheritance

will

= the legal document.

inheritance

= money/property someone receives after another person dies.

So:

> a will specifies inheritance,

but:

> a will is not the inheritance itself.

Important distinction: **will** vs testament

In legal English:

> ****last will and testament****

is an established formal expression.

In ordinary modern use:

> ****will****

alone is normally enough.

Important distinction: **will something to someone vs give**

**give**

= transfer something generally.

**will something to someone**

= specify in a legal will that they receive it after your death.

> "She gave him the house."

= transfer occurred.

> "She willed him the house."

= inheritance was specified.

Important distinction: **willing vs willing to**

**willing**

often needs context:

> "Are you willing?"

**willing to + verb**

states the exact action:

> “Are you willing to help?”

Both express voluntary readiness.

Important distinction: ****unwilling vs unable****

****unwilling****

= does not want to.

****unable****

= cannot do it.

> “She was unwilling to speak.”

= 她不願說。

> “She was unable to speak.”

= 她無法說。

Completely different.

Important distinction: ****against your will vs reluctantly****

****against your will****

= you did not consent and may have been forced.

****reluctantly****

= you did it willingly enough to do it, but with hesitation/unhappiness.

The first is much stronger.

Important distinction: ****at will vs whenever****

****at will****

= freely whenever one chooses.

whenever

= at any time / every time.

> “You can leave at will.”

emphasizes freedom of choice.

Important distinction: **free will vs freedom**

free will

= ability/concept of making choices independently.

freedom

= broader state of being unrestricted.

Related, but not interchangeable.

Family-extension sweep

The practical **will** family is exceptionally rich because the modal and noun/verb meanings split into several branches:

* **will — future prediction** = 將會 / 會

* **will — future fact** = 將會

* **will — spontaneous decision** = 我來 / 我要.....

* **I'll... — offer** = 我來.....

* **will — willingness** = 願意 / 肯

* **won't — refusal** = 不肯

* **will — promise** = 一定會

* **will — determination** = 決意 / 一定要

* **Will you...? — request** = 可以請你.....嗎？

* **Will you...? — willingness** = 你願意.....嗎？

* **will — habitual tendency** = 往往 / 總會

* **will — confident inference** = 想必 / 大概是

* **won't — malfunction/refusal of object** = 怎樣都不.....

* **will — noun: determination** = 意志 / 決心

* **strong will** = 堅強意志
 * **will to live/succeed** = 求生 / 成功意志
 * **willpower** = 意志力 / 自制力
 * **will — noun: legal document** = 遺囑
 * **make a will** = 立遺囑
 * **last will and testament** = 正式遺囑
 * **will something to someone** = 遺贈
 * **will yourself to do** = 靠意志迫使自己做
 * **willing** = 願意的
 * **willingly** = 自願 / 樂意地
 * **willingness** = 意願
 * **unwilling** = 不願意的
 * **against someone's will** = 違背某人意願
 * **of your own free will** = 出於自願
 * **free will** = 自由意志
 * **at will** = 隨意 / 任意
 * **the will of the people** = 人民意願

The main semantic/function branches are:

- > **future prediction / expectation**
- > **decision, promise, willingness, refusal**
- > **habitual or characteristic behaviour**
- > **determination / intention**
- > **legal inheritance document**
- > **voluntary willingness**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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will — future prediction	表示說話者預期 / 相信某件事情將在未來發生
will — future fact	表示按時間、安排或自然發展將在未來成立
will — spontaneous decision	在說話當刻立即決定自己接下來要做某事
I'll... — offer	主動表示自己願意替別人做某事
will — willingness	某人願意 / 肯選擇進行某項行動
won't — refusal	某人拒絕、不肯進行某項行動
will — promise	向別人承諾自己未來一定會採取某項行動
will — determination	強烈表達自己決意要某事發生 / 完成

Will you...? — request	詢問 / 請求對方是否願意替自己做某事	
will — habitual tendency	表示某人 / 某物典型、反覆出現的行為或傾向	
will — confident inference	根據目前情況作出把握較高的推斷	
won't — object malfunction	某物儘管嘗試仍無法按預期運作	
will — determination noun	推動某人堅持、選擇或克服困難的內在意志	
strong will	不容易被困難動搖的堅定決心	
willpower	控制衝動、克服困難、堅持目標的心理力量	
will — legal document	說明死後財產 / 資產如何處理的法律文件	
will something to someone	在這囑中指定某人 / 機構繼承某項財產	
will yourself to do	靠強烈意志迫使 / 鼓勵自己完成某事	
willing	樂意、自願、願意選擇做某事的	
willingly	並非被迫，而是出於自己意願地	
willingness	願意接受 / 進行某事的態度	
unwilling	不願選擇進行某項行動的	
against someone's will	某事在違背當事人意願、甚至被迫的情況下發生	
of your own free will	沒有被迫，由自己自由選擇	
free will	人自主、獨立作出選擇的能力 / 概念	
at will	按自己的意願，在想要時自由地進行	
will of the people	個人 / 群體希望某個結果發生的集體意願	

For your original passage

> “I know that one day these visits **will become memories**, and I want to learn from her while I can.”

The exact meaning is:

will = expresses an expected future development

Therefore:

> **these visits will become memories**

= **「這些探訪有一天終會變成回憶」**

The speaker is not making:

> a promise

or:

> a voluntary decision.

The visits themselves do not “want” to become memories.

Instead, **will** expresses the speaker's recognition of an expected future reality:

- > grandmother is getting older
- > → the present situation cannot last forever
- > → eventually these visits will belong to the past.

This creates an especially important contrast with the **can** in the same sentence:

- > "these visits **will** become memories"

= what the speaker expects **will** happen in the future

but:

- > "while I **can**"

= what the speaker **still** has the opportunity to do now

So:

- > **will** → future expectation

- > **can** → present opportunity

The most important learner contrasts are:

- > **It will happen.**

> = 它會發生。

- > → future prediction

- > **I'll answer the phone.**

> = 我來接電話。

- > → immediate decision

- > **I'll help you.**

> = 我會幫你。

- > → offer/promise

- > **She will help if you ask.**

> = 你開口她就願意幫忙。

- > → willingness

- > **He won't apologize.**

> = 他就是不肯道歉。

- > → refusal

> ****Will you help me?****

> = 可以請你幫我嗎？

> → request

> ****Children will ask questions.****

> = 孩子總會問問題。

> → characteristic behaviour

> ****That'll be John.****

> = 那大概就是 John。

> → confident inference

> ****The car won't start.****

> = 車子怎樣都發動不了。

> → failure to function

> ****a strong will****

> = 堅強意志

> ****willpower****

> = 意志力 / 自制力

> ****a will****

> = 遺囑

> ****make a will****

> = 立遺囑

> ****will the house to her daughter****

> = 在遺囑中把房子留給女兒

> ****be willing to help****

> = 願意幫忙

> ****against his will****

> = 違背他的意願

> ****of her own free will****

> = 她自願地

> ****free will****

> = 自由意志

So ****will**** is far richer than simply:

> **will = 將會**

and in your original passage it specifically means:

“the speaker expects that, as time passes, these present visits will inevitably become memories of the past.”